

What do you do when leftovers simply aren't appealing on their own? Turn them into a new recipe, of course!

- If you have leftover meat, make a sandwich the next day, or sprinkle on a salad.
- If you have leftover mashed potatoes, shape into patties and cook in a skillet to make potato pancakes.
- If you have leftover veggies and noodles, make a soup. The possibilities are endless!

Another thing I like to do is warm up leftovers on the stove or in a convection oven. It seems to revive refrigerated food a lot better than the microwave.

4. SHOP DISCOUNT FOOD STORES

Discount grocery stores, such as Aldi or Save-A-Lot offer brands that are priced much lower than products sold at regular grocers. Try switching over most of your shopping to one of these stores, and you'll see a big difference in your budget. Not every brand is over-the-top amazing, so you'll want to do some trial and error before you get a hang of what's good and what's not.

Be sure to visit a discounted bread store too if you're lucky enough to have one in your area. These stores sell bread products that expire in a day or so, but bread always freezes well. Use this as your golden opportunity to stock up and save!

Lastly, there are scratch and dent stores available with discounted and "damaged" goods similar to what you would find at a furniture outlet. These stores offer products at a fraction of the price, and rarely have anything wrong with them besides mismatched labels and an actual dent or two. The blog *A Mom's Paradise* has a pretty comprehensive list of scratch and dent stores by state, which you can access at

CreativeSavingsBlog.com/Dent